

found to be the deepest in the Americas, extending to 5,069 ft (1,545 m) beneath the surface. Explorers have to dive through long submerged sections to reach the deepest point of the 40-mile- (64-km-) long system. When dye was put in the system's water, it was found to discharge at a spring in the Santa Domingo Canyon, at a much lower level, indicating that more passages are yet to be discovered. As the canyon has cut deeper, it has triggered changes throughout the cave system. Fresh stream passages have been formed under now-abandoned tunnels.

Sac Actun

Location Quintana Roo state, southern Mexico

Translated from the Mayan language, Sac Actun means White Cave. With a total surveyed length of 205 miles (331 km), it is the longest cave system in Mexico and the second longest on Earth. While the upper parts of this coastal system are above water, most of the system is flooded with a mixture of freshwater from inland and seawater from the Caribbean. The cave can be reached through about 170 sinkholes. Some deep flooded shafts are yet to be explored, suggesting that there are more tunnels yet to be found.

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